ThoughtSpot Research 02 — Liveboards, Sharing, Scheduling, Alerting, Collaboration

Researched 2026-08-31 from thoughtspot.com product pages, docs.thoughtspot.com (Cloud "latest" / 26.8.0.cl) and developers.thoughtspot.com. Quoted strings are copied verbatim. Anything unconfirmed is flagged [UNVERIFIED].

---

1. Liveboards

Sources: /cloud/latest/liveboards · /cloud/latest/liveboard-experience-new · /cloud/latest/liveboard-layout-edit · /cloud/latest/liveboard-notes · thoughtspot.com/product/visualize

"Liveboards are the ThoughtSpot term for a dashboard. They group and manage related search result visuals." The differentiator is that they are live, not rendered: "Liveboards always have the most current data." Marketing: "Unlike static dashboards, Liveboards provide a real-time, interactive view of your data," versus traditional dashboards described as "limited and cumbersome, requiring manual input."

- Tiles. Users "pin charts and tables to any Liveboard" they created or can edit.
- Tabs (since 8.7.0.cl): "Separate your Liveboard into multiple tabs, grouping specific visualizations together in each tab" — e.g. an exec KPI tab plus a manager detail tab. Added via + Add tab in edit mode; a tile moves with More → Move to tab.
- Note tiles. Edit → Add note places a rich-text tile anywhere: H1–H2, bold/italic/underline/strikethrough, lists, tables, hyperlinks, images (max 5 MB), iFrame embeds. Used for "defining terminology used in the dashboard" and explaining complex visualizations.
- Layout. Edit mode only ("To make changes to your Liveboard… you must be in edit mode"); Edit sits upper-right, greyed out without privileges. Drag by the bar atop a tile; resize freehand from the corner or pick from the Tile size menu (five presets). It is a "relative flow layout"; the new experience promises "Other tiles will not move unexpectedly."
- Undo / redo / reset sit left of Explore; reset restores "its last saved state."
- More options menu: Present (live slideshow), Download as PDF, Export TML, Create schedule / Manage schedule, verification actions.

Removed in the new experience: sharing an individual visualization (replaced by copy-link), switching Liveboards from the title, copy-embed-link.

---

2. Filters, cross-filtering, personalised views

Sources: /cloud/latest/liveboard-filters · /liveboard-filters-cross · /personalized-liveboard-views

Filter chips run in a row beneath the Liveboard name and description; clicking one opens the filter window. Two modes: in view mode a read-only user changes filter values only (include/exclude); in edit mode you control defaults, which visualizations the filter applies to, and linked filters.

Liveboard-level vs visualization-level. By default a filter applies to all visualizations based on Models, but a creator can "specify the visualizations or tabs that a Liveboard filter should apply to." Types: bulk, exclude, linked (columns across Models), and mandatory (asterisked; "visualizations won't load until values are selected").

Key governance nuance: "When you apply a filter, the Liveboard is not automatically saved with your filter applied." Persisting one needs edit access to the Liveboard and view access to the data source. That is what makes read-only exploration safe.

Cross filters ("brushing and linking"): right-click a data point → Filter to filter the whole board by that value. They land in the same filter bar; removed via Remove filter, the hover x, or Clear all (which clears cross filters but preserves permanent ones). They are "not permanent, and do not appear to other users," apply only to attributes, and dates are unsupported.

Personalised views are the standout. Apply filters → Save → Save view → name it → optionally tick Make view available to all users (needs edit permission) → Save. The view "retain[s] the filter values, and remain[s] synced with the original Liveboard" — a bookmark, not a fork; the URL carries a view_ID. Unsaved edits show "a dot… next to the view name"; click the name → Update. Managed via Select view → Manage views. Limits: not in ThoughtSpot Mobile; "New filters can't be added in a personalized Liveboard, they must be added in the original"; deleting the original deletes all its views; with RLS on, "the filter chip preview and tooltip do not follow RLS."

---

3. Sharing & permissions

Sources: /cloud/latest/share-liveboards · /share-answers · /sharing · developers.thoughtspot.com/docs/access-control-sharing

Framing: "Whenever you are working in ThoughtSpot, you are in your own private environment until you share your work with others."

Two modes, per recipient, from a dropdown: Can View — "Provides read-only access"; Can Edit — "Allows modification. Enables renaming or deleting the shared object" (edits save automatically). API equivalents READ_ONLY / MODIFY.

Recipients are users or groups. "You can only enter email addresses whose domains are in your list of allowed domains" (an info icon reveals the list); an x removes a row. Under multi-tenancy "you can only share with other users in your specific Org."

Object access and data access are separate axes, shown inline. If a recipient lacks data access a black warning symbol appears; the sharer ticks "Give view access to underlying data sources." If they don't own the source, "ThoughtSpot emails the owner or administrator to request access," and once granted "the warning symbol turns into a green checkmark." This is the best idea in the flow.

Link sharing is deliberately not access-granting: "Sending users this link does not share the object with them. You must also share the object by selecting the Share button."

What a recipient sees: "the most recently saved version with the most recent data" — it re-runs; it is not a snapshot. Shared Answers "appear in their most recent state — including any filters added after the initial save."

Cascade: "If you share Can View or Can Edit privileges for an object with other people, they can further share them with others." No documented "viewers cannot reshare" lock.

Discoverability is a third mode: marking an item discoverable exposes it to your groups subject to data access; others must "request access."

Caveat: if a hidden column appears in a pinned Answer, "the entire Liveboard becomes read-only to users," blocking filter changes and downloads.

Re-running per viewer is confirmed for interactive viewing (latest data, RLS applies) and for scheduled delivery (§4). A developer-doc line — "When an object is shared, users can view all the data regardless of the permissions set at the parent object level" — appears to concern parent-object permissions rather than RLS; treat the exact interaction as [UNVERIFIED].

---

4. Scheduling & delivery

Sources: /cloud/latest/schedule-liveboards · /liveboard-schedule · /scheduled-liveboards-management · /cloud/10.13.0.cl/liveboard-gating-condition-example

Entry: More → Create schedule (or Manage schedule). Global view: Data > Utilities > View Liveboard schedules.

Field	Detail
Name	Unique; "doesn't appear in the email"
Add Comment	Renders as "Description: <your content>" in the email body
Frequency	Every n minutes (5/10/15/20/30/45), Hourly, Daily, Weekly, Monthly. Anchored to "your time zone's start of day (00:00)", not creation time
File type	PDF · CSV · XLSX (+ advanced PDF layout / which visualizations / which tabs)
Email body	Optional commentary
Add Snapshot of Liveboard (Early Access)	PNG of the main tab
AI Highlights	"quick metric insights on how key performance indicators have changed"
Gating Condition	Boolean, e.g. sum (revenue) > 100
Recipients	Users, groups, external emails (admin-approved domains). Max 1,000
Views	Send a saved personalised view instead of the default state

PDF holds all visualizations in one attachment but tables are "limited to first 100 rows"; CSV/XLSX are table-data only, one attachment per table, all rows. A corrupted Liveboard blocks CSV/XLSX entirely; PDF renders "empty/error slots." Email cap 22 MB; since 9.2.0.cl admins can disable attachments. Email: from admin, subject "<Liveboard name> update", body = greeting + description + a View Liveboard button.

Per-recipient security: "Scheduled Liveboards adhere to row-level security rules." ThoughtSpot-user recipients "see only data they have view-level access to"; external recipients get data "based on the scheduler's permissions." Gating conditions evaluate per user — queries "execute under their credentials to respect row-level security… If a recipient lacks data access, the schedule skips sending to that user while delivering to others with access."

Gating conditions must return a single boolean (sum (revenue) > 100 valid; is_weekend (commit_date) invalid, "returns per-row results"), all columns from one source — picking a column locks the source. Worked example: sales variance >20% DoD, product count outside 4000–5500, customers below 20,000.

Management: bulk Delete / Resume / Pause; per-job Pause/Resume/Edit/Delete; expanding a row shows "start and end times of the job, as well as the status." Non-admins see only their own. "You can have up to 50 scheduled jobs on your cluster at time." Deleting a Liveboard deletes its schedules. Scheduling for others needs the "can schedule for others" privilege, which ThoughtSpot advises being conservative with. You cannot unsubscribe from a schedule you created — "only the creator can manage it."

---

5. Monitoring / KPI alerts

Sources: /cloud/latest/monitor · /monitor-alert-threshold · /cloud/10.10.0.cl/monitor-alert-attributes · developers.thoughtspot.com/docs/webhooks-kpi

Alerts hang off KPI charts, not Liveboards. "KPI charts must be saved as Answers before creating alerts," and "Pinned KPI visualizations in edit mode cannot have alerts created."

Start: hover the KPI tile → Monitor icon (upper right), or more options → Create alert. A type-picker offers "KPI crosses a set limit", "Values of an attribute crosses a set limit", "Regular updates on values of an attribute", plus scheduled (hourly/daily/weekly/monthly) and Anomaly alerts (emails now show "upper and lower expected-behavior boundaries").

Threshold config: optional Alert name; operators Greater than, Greater than or equal to, Less than, Less than or equal to, Equal to, Not equal to; for time-series KPIs also Changes by (%), Increases by (%), Decreases by (%). Frequency shows a default with a

change link; hourly alerts are "sent at 30- or 60-minute mark"; timezone selectable, plus a weekend-delivery choice. Optional Custom message and Query details.

Recipients: you auto-populate; add teammates or groups — but "Users must be removed from the group to be removed from the alert schedule." View access lets you subscribe people who already have view access; edit access lets you subscribe anyone. "Alert subscriptions respect RLS settings — subscribers see only data within their permitted scope."

Channels: Email and Custom channel (webhook). Slack is Early Access — the creator connects their Slack account and the Spotter app must be in the destination channel. Webhooks POST JSON (SchemaVersion: v1, EventSchemaType: MONITOR, NotificationType, CurrentUser, MonitorRuleForWebhook, RuleExecutionDetails). Microsoft Teams as a native alert channel is [UNVERIFIED] — the Slack marketing page mentions Spotter in Slack and Teams, but Monitor docs list only Email, Slack (EA) and Custom channel.

Managing: Insights tab → Monitor subscriptions, with All (created or subscribed) vs Yours; subscribe/unsubscribe, edit, change notification settings. Also More → Manage alerts → Edit alert. Alert emails link to view, modify or unsubscribe.

Noise control is weak. No per-alert snooze or mute is documented [UNVERIFIED / not found]. Instead there is an admin floor — Admin > Search & SpotIQ > SpotIQ Settings > "Shortest time period to check alerts" — which removes faster cadences from the user's picker entirely. Plus a sampling caveat: "If your KPI temporarily satisfies the threshold condition, but does not satisfy the condition at the time the threshold condition is next checked, you will not receive an alert notification."

---

6. Collaboration

Sources: /cloud/latest/liveboard-comment · /liveboard-verify · /chart-kpi

Comments ("Collaborative Liveboards") are disabled by default and need admin activation. Entry is "the Comment icon… to the left of the More menu icon." Comments live in a right sidebar you can reposition ("select the dot icon and drag across the screen"); ESC or the x exits. @ mentions email the taggee; "a red dot appears on the comment icon" for unread. The more-options menu offers share-to-Slack, unsubscribe from the thread, and resolve.

The clever part: comments pin to the data state at creation. If the visualization later changes, comments become "unattached" but stay in the sidebar, and clicking the associated data point shows the original values. Anyone with Liveboard access can comment — "there's no group-based separation" — and you can tag any cluster user. Not supported in embedded.

Verified Liveboards. Admins grant the "Can verify" privilege. Authors/editors request verification from the more-options menu with an optional message; verifiers are notified and click Approve. A verified Liveboard "carries a banner that signifies that they have been audited for correctness"; the icon "appears on the home page and the Liveboards page" and lists sort on the Verified column. After an edit, "a banner appears that informs users the content has been edited and may need to be re-verified," persisting until re-verified. Any verifier can pick Remove verification.

Following = the KPI Watchlist. "Add KPIs to your watchlist" on Home, or more options → "Add to watchlist" on a KPI tile or saved Answer. Adding auto-schedules an alert "based on each KPI's cadence." Tiles show a sparkline where "the two most recent data points are highlighted," plus percent change labelled WoW / DoD / MoM. The Liveboards doc mentions "Following Liveboards or KPIs for scheduled updates," but I found no Liveboard-level Follow control distinct from schedules/watchlist — [UNVERIFIED].

---

7. Search & find

Sources: /cloud/latest/thoughtspot-one-homepage · /cloud/26.7.0.cl/search-answers

Home (via Home or the logo) is a find-first surface: 1) Search Answers / "Search your library" — "search across all existing Answers, Liveboards, and visualizations in Liveboards," with a data-source dropdown, type-ahead, and results showing object type, author and location; 2) KPI Watchlist row with drag-to-reorder and per-KPI More options; 3) Recently viewed — "all Answers and Liveboards you have access to, in order of how recently you viewed them," 20 per page; 4) Trending — "the top 5 trending Liveboards and Answers among all users in your environment on the right panel."

Filter by object type, tags, authors and a favourites toggle; sort by author, view count, last viewed. Bulk actions: favourite, share, tag, delete, export TML. Index lag is "within 10 minutes (typically under 5 minutes)" and covers new objects, deletions and permission changes. English GA, other languages Beta.

Design lessons for Spiff

1. Make "live, re-run per viewer" visible, not a footnote. ThoughtSpot's whole pitch is "Liveboards always have the most current data." Spiff should state it on the share dialog: "Runs fresh for each person, using their own permissions."
2. Separate object access from data access and show both inline. Warning symbol → "Give view access to underlying data sources" → green checkmark is the best pattern here. Show, per recipient, whether they will actually see anything, with a request-access path.
3. Copy link ≠ grant access — say it in the UI. "Sending users this link does not share the object with them." Non-technical users assume a URL is a permission.
4. Exploring must never mutate the shared thing. "When you apply a filter, the Liveboard is not automatically saved with your filter applied." Let anyone poke at a shared answer safely, with a clear "this change is only yours" affordance.
5. Steal "Save view" over "Duplicate." Personalised views keep filter state and stay synced to the original — personalisation without forking. Spiff's contrasting rule (sharing an automation clones it) should then be presented as a deliberate, explained choice.
6. The unsaved-change dot + "Update" is a cheap, legible state model. No modal, no save-bar.
7. Gating conditions are the killer scheduling feature — "only email me if revenue drops below X." Offer it in plain language, not a boolean expression box; ThoughtSpot's single-boolean / single-source constraints are exactly what trips business users up.
8. Cadence pickers should be small and opinionated, and must preview the literal next send. "Anchored to start of day (00:00), not creation time" is a real gotcha.
9. Show per-recipient security consequences at schedule time. Internal users get RLS-filtered data; external emails get the scheduler's data. That split is a leak risk buried in prose — render it as a visible list, or refuse the external case.
10. Attach the "why" to the artefact. Note tiles, the schedule's Add Comment → "Description:" line, and per-alert Custom message all give recipients context without a separate message. Cheap to build, high trust payoff.
11. A trust badge needs a staleness rule. The bit worth stealing isn't the badge — it's the banner saying content "has been edited and may need to be re-verified."
12. Ship the noise story ThoughtSpot lacks. No per-alert snooze exists; only an admin "Shortest time period to check alerts" floor, plus silent dropping of transient breaches. Spiff should offer per-alert snooze/cooldown and state the sampling behaviour plainly.
13. Group subscriptions must have an individual exit. "Users must be removed from the group to be removed from the alert schedule" is a support-ticket generator. Always allow a personal unsubscribe and show why someone is subscribed ("via GST Managers group").
14. One management screen, not two. ThoughtSpot splits schedules (Data > Utilities) from alerts (Insights → Monitor subscriptions). Spiff needs a single "everything scheduled or watched — mine and shared with me" view with pause/resume, last-run status and next run.
15. Home should be a find surface, not a dashboard. Search + watchlist + recently viewed + trending + tag/author/favourite filters is a strong, unglamorous template; "top 5 trending"

is the cheapest social-proof discovery mechanism on the page.
16. Be honest about freshness latency. "ThoughtSpot indexes changes within 10 minutes" — including permission changes — prevents "why can't Bob see it yet?" tickets.

Screens/components worth stealing

- Share dialog with per-recipient data-access status — warning symbol → "Give view access to underlying data sources" → green checkmark.
- Can View / Can Edit dropdown per recipient row, with an x to remove.
- Allowed-domains info icon beside the recipient field, for external sharing.
- Copy link button paired with a disclaimer that the link grants no access.
- Filter chip bar under the title, with Clear all that preserves permanent filters.
- Filter modal with an "applies to these visualizations/tabs" selector — scope made explicit.
- Right-click data point → Filter cross-filter, with Remove filter on the same menu.
- Mandatory-filter asterisk with tiles that refuse to load until a value is chosen.
- Save → Save view flow with a "Make view available to all users" checkbox.
- View-name dot for unsaved changes + click-name → Update.
- Select view → Manage views table (public toggle per view, delete).
- Create schedule dialog — Name / Add Comment / Frequency / File type / Email body / Recipients / Views / Gating Condition in one scroll.
- Gating condition field — "only deliver when this is true."
- Schedules table with bulk Pause / Resume / Delete and expandable per-run history.
- KPI tile Monitor icon on hover as the one-click entry into alerting.
- Alert type picker with plain-language options ("KPI crosses a set limit").
- Monitor subscriptions list with All / Yours tabs.
- Comment sidebar — draggable, @mentions, red unread dot, resolve, share-to-Slack.
- Unattached-comment pattern — a comment survives a chart change and still links to its original data point.
- Verified badge + "may need to be re-verified" banner; sortable Verified column.
- Home KPI Watchlist row — sparkline with the two latest points highlighted, WoW/DoD/MoM deltas.
- Recently viewed + Trending (top 5) panels.
- Library search type-ahead showing object type, author and location per result.
- Note tile — rich text, images and iFrames placed anywhere in the grid.
- Tile size preset menu alongside freehand corner-drag resize.